

CMMC scoping decision worksheet

Use this before choosing a level or estimating the work. The contract, the information handled, and the systems that touch it determine the scope.

Company

Reviewer

Solicitation, contract, or purchase order

Review date

Work through the questions in order

1	Read the contract language Do the solicitation, contract, or flowdown clauses require safeguarding or an assessment?
	YES: Record each clause and continue. Do not rely on a verbal summary from a customer or prime. NO OR UNCERTAIN: Ask the contracting party to confirm the requirement in writing before selecting a CMMC level.
2	Identify the information Will the company receive, create, store, process, or transmit Federal Contract Information (FCI)?
	YES: Level 1 or another Phase I self-assessment duty may apply. Continue to the CUI question. NO OR UNCERTAIN: Document why the work is outside the FCI scope and keep the written contract confirmation.
3	Check for CUI Will the company handle Controlled Unclassified Information (CUI), including controlled drawings, specifications, or technical data?
	YES: Level 2 and NIST SP 800-171 requirements may apply. Identify the CUI category and the systems that touch it. NO OR UNCERTAIN: Do not assume Level 1 yet. Confirm that controlled information will not enter the company through a portal, email, drawing package, or subcontractor workflow.
4	Draw the system boundary Can the company name every system, person, location, vendor, and device that stores, processes, or transmits the covered information?
	YES: Use that boundary for the SSP, assessment, evidence collection, and score working papers. NO OR UNCERTAIN: Pause scoring. A number calculated before the boundary is known may describe the wrong environment.
5	Record the decision Is the level and assessment basis supported by the contract, the information category, and written confirmation for any ambiguity?
	YES: Record the conclusion and owner below. Recheck when the contract or information flow changes. NO OR UNCERTAIN: Do not affirm or submit a score yet. Escalate the unanswered contract or scoping question.

Decision record

Provisional level or requirement

Written confirmation received from

Information category and source

Boundary owner

Next action and owner

Due date

CURRENT PROGRAM NOTE

The Department suspended CMMC Phase II on July 13, 2026. Phase I self-assessments and contract-driven NIST SP 800-171 duties remain. Always treat the current solicitation and contract as controlling and verify program changes at dodcio.defense.gov/CMMC.

This worksheet supports an initial scoping conversation. It is not a certification decision or legal advice. Helm prepares organizations for assessment but does not certify them.